

# Trump delays attack on Iran

President extends deadline for opening strait, says talks have begun. Iran denies it.

By KEVIN RECTOR AND NABIH BULOS

BEIRUT — President Trump and Iranian officials gave conflicting statements Monday about a possible deal to end the war — with Trump extending a deadline he'd set for bombing Iranian power plants and claiming negotiations were under-way, while Iran denied having any dialogue with Trump officials.

"We are in the throes of a real possibility of making a deal," Trump told reporters Monday. "If I were a betting man, I'd bet for it — but again, I'm not guaranteeing anything."

Trump's remarks followed an early-morning social media post in which he said the U.S. was postponing its planned strikes on Iranian power plants and energy infrastructure for five days based on "very good and productive conversations regarding a complete and total resolution of our hostilities in the Middle East."

The president had warned Saturday that the U.S. would "obliterate" Iran's power plants unless it opened the Strait of Hormuz within 48 hours.

Oil prices, high in early trading Monday as the conflict continued to disrupt oil tanker traffic through the crucial strait, plunged after Trump's announcement — a shift he alluded to in his later remarks.

"The price of oil will drop like a rock as soon as a deal is done. I guess it already is today," he said.

Iranian officials, meanwhile, suggested Trump was lying about negotiations in order to salvage oil prices and in response to Iran's own threats of retaliation if [See Iran, A3]

# Call for early wind warning ignored

Just before Eaton blaze, one county official urged a phone alert over conditions.

By GRACE TOOHEY

Almost two hours before the Eaton fire broke out in the San Gabriel foothills Jan. 7, 2025, Los Angeles County emergency management officials had been pushed to send out an emergency alert to warn residents that increasingly high winds would pose a significant risk.

But no such alert was sent.

The residents of west Altadena did not receive an emergency alert until 3:30 a.m. the next day, nine hours after the fire started — and almost 12 hours after an emergency management employee urged a prefire alert. All but one of the Eaton fire's 19 deaths occurred in west Altadena.

Working side by side with National Weather Service officials, an emergency management staffer around 4:30 p.m. had called for a cell-phone blast across the Interstate 210 corridor — a stretch of foothill communities that includes Sylmar, Altadena and Sierra Madre — to warn people that they needed to prepare for dangerous [See Warning, A11]



IN CENTRAL TEHRAN, demonstrators wave Iranian flags to show support for the embattled government.

MAJID SAEEDI Getty Images

# Is this L.A. rail's 'missing link'?

A proposed K Line extension would create a major north-south corridor.

By JENNY JARVIE

In the decades since Los Angeles began building a modern rail network, officials have been waiting for the moment the system gets big enough, and goes enough places, that it becomes a viable alternative to driving a car.

To backers, a new Metro plan for a northern extension of the K Line — projected to boost the number of riders on the light rail line up to 100,000 a day — could be a major step toward forging a dynamic mass transit culture in L.A.

The K Line northern extension underground light rail project, which the L.A. County Metropolitan Transportation Authority's board is set to vote on this week, would extend the existing K Line from Crenshaw/Expo to Hollywood.

Metro's proposed 9.7-mile route from San Vicente to Fairfax would add nine stations and connect Angelenos to major job centers

## Expanding to Hollywood

Possible routes to extend the Metro K Line to Hollywood Boulevard



SEAN GREENE Los Angeles Times

such as Cedars-Sinai Medical Center and popular destinations such as West Hollywood, Pacific Design Center and the Grove. A 10th station would be built at the Hollywood Bowl. The project would also significantly bolster L.A. County's broader rail grid network, transit experts say, by linking up with four major rail lines and six of the county's busiest bus lines.

"It's really going to change people's geography of L.A.," Jacob Wasserman, research program manager at the UCLA Institute of Transportation Studies, said of the K Line extension. "It's creating this nice grid network of rail, so that you can get anywhere in the city with ideally just one transfer at most by rail. ... It'll change people's mental model of the city where they live or work."

Los Angeles has spent billions investing in light rail infrastructure over the last four decades, but it is still struggling to get more people to ride. Other line openings have come with hopes and hype, but some view the K Line extension as different, in part because it will connect to a larger network that now includes a key subway through downtown L.A. [See Metro, A7]

# THE BITCOIN SCAMMER, THE FIXER AND THE COP

Daniel landed in Los Angeles with his girlfriend and a hard drive containing \$350,000 in bitcoin.

The 17-year-old's lifestyle was intended to draw attention: Parties at the hottest clubs. Rented sports cars. Cuban link chains. Imitation Richard Mille watches.

California is full of young people who were transformed into millionaires when crypto went mainstream. But Daniel didn't just buy digital money when it was cheap and watch it skyrocket in value. He stole it.

The teenager — who was identified only by his first name when he testified as a cooperating witness at a recent trial — was part of some-

A trial in Los Angeles reveals the ostentatious and sometimes illicit world of newly minted millionaire 'crypto kids'

By MATTHEW ORMSETH AND LIBOR JANY

thing called "the comm," which federal authorities say was a loose network of con artists who treated defrauding investors of millions of dollars like a game.

Holed up in lavish rental homes in Encino and Malibu, they hatched schemes to trick people into giving up access to crypto accounts with nine-figure balances. They gleefully screen-recorded some of the heists, prosecutors wrote in court documents charging them with racketeering, fraud and money laundering.

For Daniel, a rail-thin teenager with a wispy goatee and thick black hair, the fun was not necessarily [See Crypto, A6]

# Raising a stink over popular menu item

Complaints and city fines prompt a Taiwanese spot to remove tofu dish



KAYLA BARTKOWSKI Los Angeles Times

AT GOLDEN LEAF, a restaurant in San Gabriel, stinky tofu accounts for up to 20% of total revenue.

JENN HARRIS RESTAURANT CRITIC

Stinky tofu is no longer on the menu at Golden Leaf restaurant in San Gabriel after the city received complaints about the dish's aroma. But the family behind the restaurant is fighting to bring back the popular Taiwanese street food, prized for its distinct, potent stench.

"The scene of stinky tofu in Taiwanese night markets is an invitation to community and tradition," said David Liao. He owns Golden Leaf, located in a strip mall at the corner of North Mission Drive and West Las Tunas Drive in San Gabriel.

The dish, known as chou doufu in Chinese, is "a cher-

ished taste of home and a source of cultural pride," he said.

There are several restaurants in the San Gabriel Valley that offer the dish, with most deep-frying squares of the tofu, resulting in a crisp exterior and a porous, sponge-like center. The flavor and smell can range from mild to eye-wateringly stinky, like an extra funky blue cheese or excellent kimchi.

For three years it was the signature dish at Golden Leaf, until a neighbor decided they didn't like the smell. In the fall of 2017, a neighbor who lives in one of the properties north of the restaurant began calling.

"She said she could smell the stinky tofu, but we and [See Tofu, A11]

# Justices sound skeptical of late ballots

California law counts them if postmarked by election day. But high court may nullify that.

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — Californians may be forced to put their ballots in the mail well before election day to be certain they will be counted.

That's the likely outcome of a Republican challenge to mail-in ballots that came before the Supreme Court on Monday.

The court's six conservatives sounded ready to rule that federal law requires that ballots must be received by election day if they are to be counted as legal.

In the 19th century, Congress set a national day for federal elections on a Tuesday in early November, but it did not say how or when states would count their ballots. The Constitution leaves it to states to decide the "times, places and manners for holding elections."

California and 13 other states count mail-in ballots that were cast before the close of election day but arrive a few days late. And most states accept late ballots from members of the military who are stationed overseas.

By law, California counts ballots that are postmarked by election day and arrive within seven days. In 2024, more than 406,000 of these late-arriving ballots were counted in California, about 2.5% of the total.

Other Western states — Washington, Oregon, Nevada and Alaska — also count late-arriving mail ballots.

With the midterm election looming in November, President Trump has repeatedly claimed that voting by mail leads to fraud — an occurrence election experts call exceedingly rare — and the Republican National Committee has taken up the cause. The case before the Supreme Court on Monday was the GOP's challenge of a law in Mississippi, which accepts ballots that arrive up to five days after election day.

Though the Constitution and election laws accord the president no role, Trump has said he would like to "nationalize" elections and require voters to show proof that they are U.S. citizens.

Trump had repeatedly described elections as "rigged" and fraud as an [See Ballots, A7]

## LaGuardia collision kills 2

A jet and a fire truck collide on a runway, killing both pilots and closing the New York airport. **NATION, A4**

## Cosby accuser wins lawsuit

An L.A. County jury awards more than \$19 million in damages in the 1972 sexual assault case. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

## Memories of the 1970s gas crisis

The Iran war is raising the threat of another shortage, columnist Patt Morrison writes. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

## Weather

Very warm. L.A. Basin: 87/57. **B6**

## Markets ..... A10 Opinion Voices ..... A12

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